



Gaming Smartphone

Power that plays harder

Mobile gaming hardware has levelled up fast this year, and the gap between a regular flagship and a gaming-first device has never been clearer. With more powerful chipsets, smarter cooling systems, and higher refresh rates, some phones feel built with long play sessions in mind. For this category, we looked beyond benchmarks to evaluate sustained performance, heat management, display quality, battery endurance and in-game stability. These devices consistently delivered during real-world testing.

Zero1 Winner: iQOO 13

The iQOO 13 stands out because it performs like a gaming phone without forcing you into a gamer aesthetic. Powered by the Snapdragon 8 Elite and the Q2 co-processor, the phone delivers some of the smoothest gameplay we have tested this year. Titles like BGMI and CODM ran at 144 FPS with frame stability that stayed high even during extended sessions.

The upgraded 7000 sq mm vapour chamber keeps temperatures in check and during stress tests, the device showed minimal performance drop. The 6.82-inch 2K LTPO AMOLED panel is sharp and bright, peaking at 4500 nits, and the 144 Hz refresh rate makes fast-paced games feel genuinely fluid.

Battery life is excellent with the 6000 mAh cell, and the 120W charging helps you get back into a session quickly. Bypass charging works and kept temperatures low while



iQOO 13
Price: ₹54,999

plugged in. The iQOO 13 feels like the most complete gaming package of the year, pairing raw power with real endurance.

Runner-up: Poco F7

The Poco F7 punches far above its price and delivers performance levels you would normally expect from flagships. The Snapdragon 8s Gen 4 gives it enough GPU for demanding titles, and the combination of LPDDR5X RAM and UFS 4.1 storage keeps it responsive.

The 1.5K 120 Hz AMOLED display has good touch response and peak brightness. The 3D IceLoop cooling helps in gaming, though the phone does warm up during longer high-FPS sessions. WildBoost Optimisation 4.0 and Game Turbo mode help stabilise performance, and synthetic scores around the 2 million mark reflect its strong hardware.



Poco F7
Price: ₹31,999

Best Buy: Oppo K13 Turbo Pro

The Oppo K13 Turbo Pro earns the best buy title because of something you rarely see on phones anymore: an actual cooling fan. Combined with the Snapdragon 8s Gen 4 and a large vapour chamber, the active cooling setup helps maintain performance better than most devices in this price band.

In stress tests, performance only dipped to around 82 percent of peak, which is an excellent result. Games that usually trigger quick heating stayed notably more stable when the fan was enabled. The 1.5K 120 Hz AMOLED display is solid, and the 7000 mAh battery backs it up with excellent longevity.

— Siddharth Chauhan | editor@digit.in



Oppo K13 Turbo Pro
Price: ₹37,999